

Weather



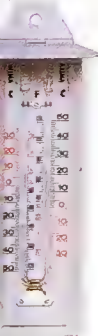
Recording the weather



Anemometers spin around quickly. They measure the speed of wind.



Weather buoys gather information about all kinds of weather conditions.



Thermometers measure how hot or cold the air is.



Barometers are used to measure the pressure of air.

Wind, sun, rain, or snow – weather is what happens in the air around us. Weather affects our lives, so forecasts warn us when it will change.

World weather

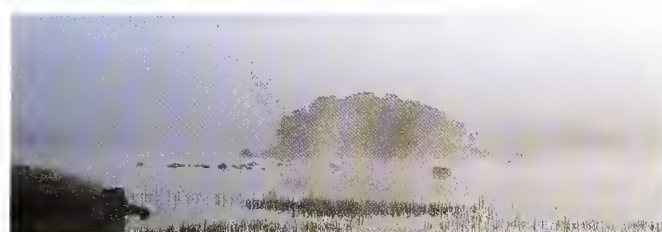
Satellites in space take pictures of the Earth. This one shows patterns of clouds around the globe.

Storm clouds



Tornado

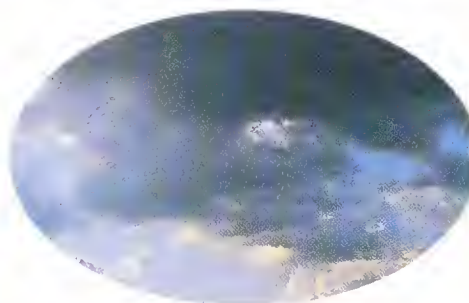
These strong, whirling winds twist at up to 300 mph (500 km/h).



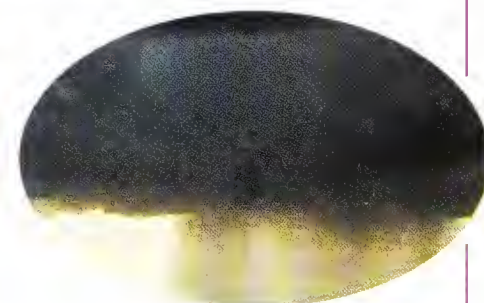
Rain



1 Clouds are made of tiny water droplets that float in the air.

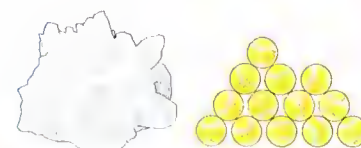


2 The clouds get darker as more water droplets join together.



3 The droplets grow bigger and heavier until they fall to the ground as rain.

Did you know?
The biggest hailstone in the world fell in North America. It was as heavy as 13 tennis balls.



Clear skies over northern Africa



Snow

Rain turns to snow when the air is very cold.

Fog

Fog is a type of cloud that forms low down on the ground.